

Ex-no:1	BASIC LINUX COMMANDS
08/01/2026	

Aim

To study and practice fundamental Linux commands used for file handling, directory navigation, and system operations.

Algorithm

1. Start the Linux terminal.
2. Execute basic navigation commands to move between directories.
3. Use file and directory management commands to create, view, copy, move, and delete files/folders.
4. Apply commands to display file contents and system information.
5. Observe and verify the output of each command.

Basic Commands

1. Directory Navigation

- `pwd` → Displays present working directory
- `ls` → Lists files and directories
- `cd <directory>` → Changes directory
- `cd ..` → Moves to parent directory

2. File and Directory Creation

- `touch file.txt` → Creates a file
- `mkdir dir1` → Creates a directory

3. File Operations

- `cp file1 file2` → Copies file
- `mv file1 file2` → Moves/renames file
- `rm file.txt` → Deletes file
- `rmdir dir1` → Removes empty directory

4. Viewing File Content

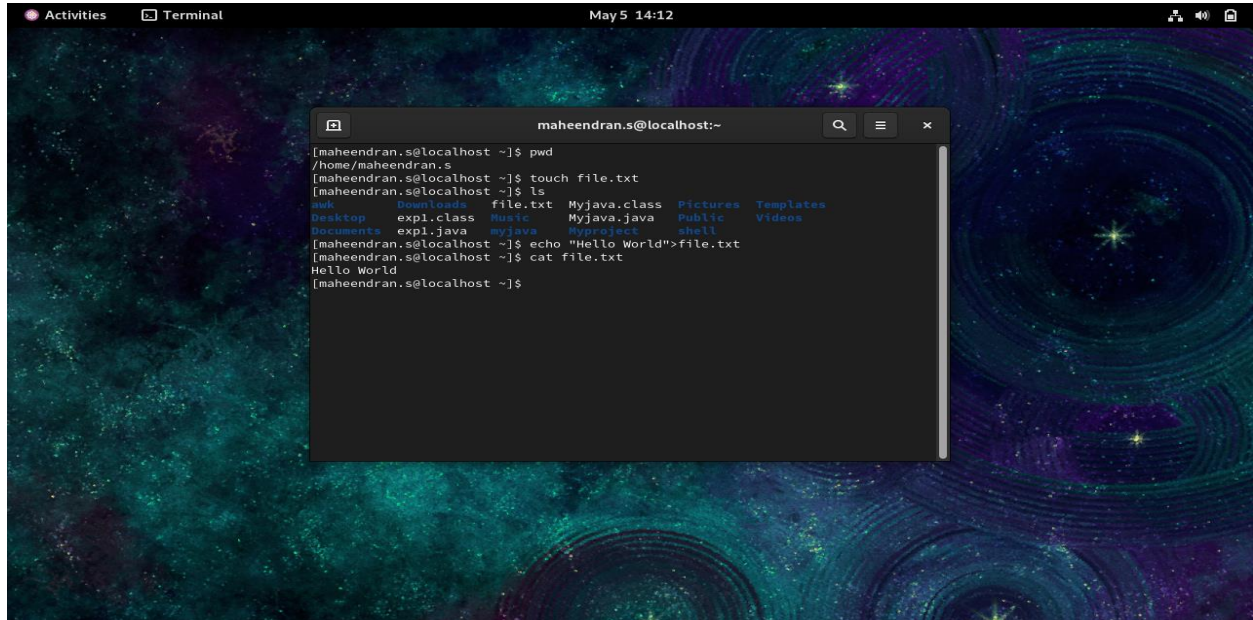
- `cat file.txt` → Displays file content
- `less file.txt` → Views content page by page
- `head file.txt` → Shows first 10 lines

- `tail file.txt` → Shows last 10 lines

5. System Information

- `whoami` → Displays current user
- `date` → Shows current date and time
- `clear` → Clears terminal screen

OUTPUT:



The screenshot shows a Linux desktop environment with a terminal window open. The terminal window has a title bar that reads "maheendran.s@localhost:~". The background of the desktop is a vibrant, abstract pattern of green, blue, and purple. The terminal window displays the following commands and their outputs:

```
[maheendran.s@localhost ~]$ pwd
/home/maheendran.s
[maheendran.s@localhost ~]$ touch file.txt
[maheendran.s@localhost ~]$ ls
mae Desktop file.txt Myjava.class Pictures Templates
Desktop exp1.class Music Myjava.java Public Videos
Documents exp1.java myjava Myproject shell
[maheendran.s@localhost ~]$ echo "Hello World">file.txt
[maheendran.s@localhost ~]$ cat file.txt
Hello world
[maheendran.s@localhost ~]$
```

Result

The basic Linux commands were successfully executed and verified. The experiment helped in understanding file handling, directory navigation, and essential system operations in the Linux environment.